

French 1995 Rulebook vs. English Rules

Comparison of the official Azure Wish rulebook (French, 1995) with the English "Decimal Version 1.0" edited by MWBigney, Historical and Open scenarios. French references are section and page of the 1995 rulebook; original French wording is quoted in *italics*. Everything else matches, including all eleven regime descriptions: set-up, Result Table, action costs and effects, regime change conditions, election formulas, victory points and final rankings. **Verdict:** the text we play by. The French rulebook prevails where it is explicit; the English rules (or the designers' answers) where the French text is ambiguous or contradicts itself; the English additions where the French text is silent.

#	Topic	Scenario	French rulebook (1995)	English rules	Question	Verdict
1	Laws under the Legislative Major	Both	[XV-A2 p.37, VII-E2 p.17] Laws are proposed only by the officially present Currents (one each, 50 assignats). The Government proposes laws only under the Terror and Thermidor (and the optional provisional regimes). « <i>proposées par les Tendances, 1 chacune, 50 assignats</i> »	[R.1.3, 7.5.2.3] The Government also proposes 1 to 3 laws, at no cost.	Where does the Government's 1-3 laws under the Legislative come from: a designer erratum, a later edition, or a translation choice?	French
2	Government laws (Terror, Thermidor, Wrath, Mercy, Directorate, Prairial) Major	Both	[VII-E2 p.17] The Government must propose 1 to 3 laws each turn. « <i>Le Gouvernement doit proposer de 1 à 3 Lois par tour de jeu</i> »	[7.5.2.3, R.3.3 and following] "3 maximum", with no minimum.	Was the obligation to propose at least one law dropped on purpose? Under the Terror it decides whether the Mountain can avoid the two rejected laws that open Thermidor.	French
3	Coalition track during foreign war Major	Both	[IX-B p.21] The marker is placed on 20 and stays there until the end of the war , i.e. until no enemy army is left in France; it may then go down with events and actions. (XI-B1 p.27 also mentions peace when the marker returns to level I.) « <i>placé sur "20" jusqu'à la fin de la guerre ; lorsqu'il n'y a plus une seule troupe ennemie en France</i> »	[9.2] The marker can move only during the Random Events phase ; the war ends when no Allied army is left or when the marker returns to level I.	Is the marker locked at 20 until no enemy army remains, as in the French text, or can events lower it during the war?	French (to confirm, see XI-B1)
4	Coups under the Legislative Major (Historical scenario)	Historical	[XI-C p.27, XV-A5 p.38] The whole coup chapter is marked "rule specific to the Open game", the Legislative limited coups included. « <i>Règle spécifique au jeu "Ouvert"</i> »	[12.0 vs 12.2, R.1.7.1] 12.0 says Open Scenario only, but 12.2 allows the limited coup "during the Legislative (HS)".	Can the Feuillant / Gironde limited coup be used in the Historical scenario?	French
5	Number of plotters (popular, limited and military coups)	Open	[XI-C p.28, XI-C3 p.28] One Personality, possibly seconded by one other (+2); same for the rally of a military coup. « <i>secondée éventuellement par une 2e Personnalité</i> »	[12.1, 12.2, 12.3.1] +2 fame for each additional Personality, no limit.	Is the number of plotters limited to two?	French
6	Successful constitutional referendum	Open	[XI-D p.29-30] The proposing Current and the Government each gain +1 fame . The referendum is held at the Government's request, at the start of the Political phase. « <i>La Tendance et le Gouvernement gagnent chacun +1 point de Renommée</i> »	[R.2.8.3.1, R.3.8.4.1, R.4.8.1.1...] No fame gain.	Was the +1 fame for a successful referendum left out on purpose?	French
7	Successful limited coup	Open	[XI-C4 p.29] The Assembly cannot criticise the Government that turn (no vote of confidence). « <i>L'Assemblée nationale ne peut pas "critiquer" la Tendance au Gouvernement ce tour-ci</i> »	[12.2.2] Not mentioned.	Should the vote of confidence be skipped the turn of a successful limited coup?	French

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8	King's trial under a fame-vote regime (Terror...)	Both	[XI-A4 p.26] The "trial law" must first pass its dice vote ; only then do the deputies vote on the King's guilt. « si le Gouvernement réussit à proposer la Loi (test de réussite d'une Loi nécessaire), un nouveau Procès a lieu »	[11.4] The deputies vote on the King's guilt as though it were a law.	Under the Terror, is there a dice test to bring the trial to a vote, then a deputies' vote?	French
9	Marat, Chaumette, Hébert, Roux (and the 4 Royalist generals under the Legislative)	Both	[XV-A p.37, XV-B p.38, VII-C1 p.13] Listed as outlaws (hors-la-loi) in the regime descriptions, yet the Marat arrest example does not apply the +5. « les Personnalités suivantes sont hors-la-loi : Marat (Mtg), Chaumette (Scu)... »	[R.1.4.1, R.2.4.1...] "Arrestable (but not outlaws)".	Resolved by the designers (Marcé, Goyon; errata XI-B2): the +5 applies only to outlawed factions, not to these leaders. The English rules are correct.	English (designers)
10	Conscription	Both	[XII-12 p.32] No condition to propose it, and nothing forbids passing it again.	[13.5.2] Only during foreign or civil war, and cannot be passed again until it has ended with peace.	Where do these two restrictions come from?	Designers : once only, no war condition
11	Re-elections of a sitting Assembly	Both	[XI-E p.30] Deputies of a Current outlawed in the previous legislature are no longer set aside but hidden in a close Current (Mountain / Sans-Culotte, Feuillant / Royalist) or in the Marais. « ne sont plus mis de côté, mais placés dans l'Assemblée "cachés" »	[R.2.6, R.3.6, R.4.6...] Not mentioned.	Should this re-election rule be added?	French
12	Combat with equal numbers of armies	Both	[IX-F p.22] Who rolls: 1) the side with more armies; 2) "the Royalist for one, the Government for the other" (ambiguous). « le joueur Royaliste pour l'un, le joueur au Gouvernement pour l'autre »	[9.6] On a tie, the revolutionary side is the attacker.	How was the French wording interpreted? Does each side roll?	English (French ambiguous)
13	King's action (Legislative)	Both	[XI-A1 p.25] The action is the move of the Coalition marker (1 box), and its consequence is -1 fame to the Gironde (or to the Feuillant). « il peut faire baisser le marqueur des Coalisés d'1 case, dans ce cas, la Renommée du Girondin baisse de -1 »	[7.5.2.2] The fame loss is the action; the Coalition move is optional .	Is the Coalition move optional?	French
14	Fatherland in Danger	Both	[XII-14 p.32] Applies as long as France is in foreign war. « Elle est appliquée tant que la France est en Guerre extérieure »	[13.6] Ends with the foreign war or with the civil war, depending on what prompted it.	Where does the civil-war case come from?	French
15	5-player game, Marais roll "4"	Both	[XIV-A p.36] "Tours controlled" (by the Marais). « 4 : Tours contrôlé »	[15.2.1.1] "Tours is controlled by the Gironde".	Is "by the Gironde" a translation error?	French
16	5-player game, Government laws	Both	[XIV-A p.36] The Government's Current may propose two laws under the Legislative and the Convention (idem First Republic). « deux Lois sous la Législative et la Convention »	[15.2.1.3] Two laws under the Convention and the First Republic.	Should the Legislative be listed?	French
17	Outlaws under the First Republic, One & Indivisible	Open	[VII-C1 p.13 vs XV-K p.51] Chapter VII groups this regime with the Terror (Gironde outlawed); the regime description outlaws only the Royalist and the Feuillant.	[R.10.4.1] Follows the regime description (Royalist and Feuillant).	Confirm the Gironde is not outlawed (internal contradiction in the French text).	English (regime description)
18	Kidnapped King recaptured	Both	[XI-A3 p.26 vs XI-A4 NB p.27] Trial "immediately" in one place, "the following turn" in another.	[11.3.1, 11.4] Trial the following turn.	Confirm the following turn (internal contradiction in the French text).	English (French contradictory)

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19	Military coup: failed rally	Open	[XI-C3 p.28] The plotting Personalities “immediately become outlaws” when the rally is attempted; if the rally fails, only the Current and the Personalities that did not take part escape outlaw status. « Ces Personnalités deviennent immédiatement hors-la-loi. [...] Si le ralliement échoue, la Tendance et les Personnalités n'ayant pas participé au coup d'Etat ne sont pas considérées hors-la-loi »	[12.3.1] “If the rally attempt fails, nothing happens”; the Personalities are outlawed only if the rally succeeds.	Are the plotters outlawed even when the rally fails?	English (French ambiguous)
20	Military coup: time of the combat in Paris	Open	[XI-C3 p.29] The combat takes place at the end of the Movement segment . « Le combat a exceptionnellement lieu à la fin de la s/phase de Mouvement »	[12.3.3] Resolved at the end of the intercepting armies' movement.	Is the combat fought before or after the other armies move?	French
21	Failed popular or military coup: the Commune	Open	[XI-C4 p.29] The plotting Current loses control of the Commune , which becomes neutral. « La Tendance perd éventuellement le contrôle de la Commune (qui redevient neutre) »	[12.1.1, 12.3.3.1] Not in the general rule; only some regime descriptions say so (R.3.7.2.2, R.4.7.2.1, R.6.7.2.1...).	Does the loss of the Commune apply to every failed popular or military coup?	French
22	Legislative: Gironde popular coup	Open	[XV-A5 p.38] The Gironde may attempt a limited or popular coup only if the Feuillant has previously succeeded a limited coup against it, or if the Commune is at level III. « le Girondin peut tenter un coup d'Etat limité/populaire contre le Feuillant si ce dernier a précédemment réussi un coup d'Etat limité contre lui ou si la Commune est en seuil III »	[R.1.7.1.2, R.1.7.2.1] The condition applies to the limited coup only; the popular coup has no precondition.	Does the condition also restrict the Gironde's popular coup?	French
23	Legislative to Convention / Terror: “12+ regions”	Both	[XV-A6 p.38] 12 or more regions controlled by the Royalist and the Coalition; no double count. « si 12+ régions sont contrôlées par le Royaliste et les Coalisés »	[R.1.8.1, R.1.8.2] A region controlled by both the Royalist and the Coalition counts twice .	Where does the double count come from?	English (French silent)
24	Coups to Prairial: who controls the Commune	Open	[XV-D4 p.43, XV-G5 p.48] Thermidor: Commune at level III “(Mtg or Scu)”; Directorate: level II (Scu) or III (Scu, Mtg). Either Current may plot with the other's Commune, which must agree (XI-C1). « la Commune doit être soulevée et en seuil III (Mtg ou Scu) »	[R.4.7.2.1-2, R.7.7.2.1-2] The Commune must be controlled by the plotting Current.	May the Mountain plot with a Sans-Culotte Commune (and vice versa)?	French
25	Directorate: number of coups to Prairial	Open	[XV-G5 NB p.48] Only one attempt: if the Mountain tries, neither it nor the Sans-Culotte may try again. « il ne peut y avoir qu'une seule tentative de coup d'Etat »	[R.7.7.2] Only the Royalist is limited to one attempt.	Was the single attempt for the Mountain / Sans-Culotte dropped on purpose?	French
26	Directorate: running the two-headed Government	Open	[XV-G3 p.47-48] Silent on the first partner and on how a new partner is chosen after a vote of no confidence; on a disagreement, only “the Current not in power (Gironde or Feuillant)” may give +2; no special timing for limited coups. « La Tendance qui n'est pas au pouvoir (entre le Girondin et le Feuillant) peut accorder un bonus de +2 »	[R.7.2, R.7.2.2, R.7.5, R.7.7.1] First partner: most deputies (Marais breaks ties); the Mountain may also give +2; re-roll ties; new partner chosen by a second Assembly vote without the old partner; limited coups just before the Political Actions.	Are these additions designer clarifications?	French for the +2 bonus; English for the rest (French silent)

#	Topic	Scenario	French rulebook (1995)	English rules	Question	Verdict
27	Mercy to Directorate: time of the referendum	Open	[XI-D p.29, XV-F p.45] Referendums are held at the Government's request at the start of the Political phase ; the new regime applies immediately. « Ceci se joue, à la demande du Gouvernement, au début de la phase d'Action politique »	[R.6.8.2] Held at the end of the turn ; the Directorate is installed at the next Political phase.	Start of the Political phase, or end of the turn?	French
28	First Republic, One & Indivisible: Sans-Culotte variant	Open	[XV-K3 p.52] Marat switches to the Sans-Culotte and can no longer be switched back by the Mountain. « Marat passe au Sans-culotte et ne peut plus être "retourné" par le Montagnard »	[R.10.9.4] Not mentioned.	Should Marat's switch be added?	French
29	Elections when the Terror is installed	Both	[XV-C1 p.40] Same Assembly after the Convention, new elections after the Federal Republic; Mountain deputies set aside after a failed coup are reinstated. Nothing for Legislative to Terror.	[R.3.6] New elections also after the Legislative; no reinstatement of Mountain deputies.	Confirm the Legislative case and the reinstatement of Mountain deputies.	English for Legislative; French for the Mountain deputies
30	Outlaws under Prairial	Open	[VII-C1 p.13 vs XV-H p.48] Chapter VII groups Prairial with the Terror (Royalist, Gironde, Feuillant); the regime description also outlaws the Marais .	[R.8.4.1] Follows the regime description (Marais outlawed).	Confirm the Marais is outlawed (internal contradiction in the French text).	English (regime description)
31	Directorate: revolutionary majority at the end	Open	[XIII-C4 NB p.35] The Mountain wins instead of the Gironde only if it is not outlawed and has more VP. « si le Montagnard n'est pas hors-la-loi, il peut gagner »	[14.3.5] Gironde or Mountain by VP, Gironde wins ties; no outlaw condition.	Should an outlawed Mountain be unable to win?	French
32	Ties for the winner	Both	[XIII-C p.35] No tie rule.	[14.3.1 to 14.3.5] Feuillant beats Marais; Mountain beats Gironde (Convention) and Sans-Culotte (Terror); Gironde beats Mountain (Directorate).	Do these tie-breakers come from the designers?	English (French silent)

English player aids checked against the French rulebook

Law	Finding
Freedom of Religion	Commune -2 in the French rulebook (XII-9 p.31) and in the English rules (13.3.3); the English "The Laws" chart says -1.
Declaration of War, Conscription	Not in the French rulebook (XII-11, XII-12 p.32), but the designers (Marcé; errata VII-E2) state that War, Fatherland in Danger and Conscription can be passed only once: the English "The Laws" chart is right.

Cross-reference errors in the English rules

Section	Text	Should read
1.1	Victory "is determined in a three-step process outlined in 15.0".	14.0
11.4	Second trial: "Thermidor (HS) or Mercy (HS)".	Mercy (OS)
14.3.5	"consult 15.4 as though the Terror had been in place".	14.4
15.2.2	Marais "controlled by the game system, exactly as 15.3.1".	15.2.1
R.2.1	Convention brought about by a Gironde coup "(see R.1.7.1 and R.1.7.3)".	R.1.7.2 and R.1.7.3
R.4.8.2	Thermidor to Prairial "By Montagne (R.5.7.2.1) or Sans-Culotte (R.5.7.2.2)".	R.4.7.2.1 and R.4.7.2.2
R.7.7.3.1	"applied immediately (see XI-C4)": French rulebook numbering.	12.3.3.2

Section	Text	Should read
R.10.1.1	"All outlaw personalities (R.9.4.1)".	R.10.4.1
R.10.1.2	"Montagne Variant (see 10.9.3) or the Sans-Culotte Variant (see 10.9.4)".	R.10.9.3, R.10.9.4
R.10.7.2	Number used twice (Switching Variants, then Popular Coups).	R.10.7.2 and R.10.7.3 (then R.10.7.4)

Also in the English rules only: optional rule 15.3 "Ever-So-Slightly More Fair Euro-ish Variant" (proposed by HSGC/NYNA players), not part of the 1995 rulebook.